Chapter 11

Eyes-on-his-Ankles

SUMMARY. Two men were digging *g‖xaru* (Lapeirousia bainesii) roots. One of them was named Eyes-on-his-Ankles. At night they lay down to sleep. The other man saw that Eyes-on-his-Ankles had no eyes on his face, and wondered where his eyes were. He flicked sand on his face but no eyes blinked. He flicked sand on his wrists, but no eyes blinked there. Then he flicked sand on his ankles, and there, the eyes blinked. "Aha," he said, "are this person's eyes placed on his ankles?" They slept and in the morning went to dig *g‖xaru* again. When the sun was going down, the man told Eyes-on-his-Ankles to drop his *g‖xaru* and let him roast it. Then he went and chopped a long wooden paddle, and put it into the fire to heat. Meanwhile Eyes-on-his-Ankles was wrapping up his *g‖xaru* in little bundles and coming back and dropping it for the man to roast, but was trying to stand far away. Nevertheless the man burned his eyes with the hot fire paddle so that they split open, and knocked him down and roasted him along with the *g‖xaru*.

SPEAKER. *|Xoan N!a'an*

RECORDED. Kauri, Botswana, 1971

TRANSCRIBED BY. *Tsamkxao Fanni |Ui, Hacky Kgami Gcao, |Ai!ae Fridrick |Kunta*

jua du tcisa ǂhai, te ‖am
a person who did lots of things, for sure
ǂ'ang
thought
ha ‖a'i n|ui ce ka
one day he again

si!aa
they all
si!a g|ae, si!a g|ae
they all, they all went
gu ka g‖xaru ka gu ka g‖xaru ka gu ka g‖xaru ka gu ka g‖xaru ka haa !'Hom-!'hom-tzi-g|a'asi
(and) dug Lapeirousia bainesii–food plant root–and dug it and dug it and dug it and then Eyes-on-his-Ankles
ehee
yes
te
and
haa !'Homtzig|a'asi te
Eyes-on-his-Ankles (short form of name) then
‖'a haa
then he
sa ku, sa ku sau ka
they two, they two were roasting it
sa n|a saua ka ko tzi
they two certainly roasted it in the bush
ee
yes
ka sa ku sau ka, ka ha
and then they two roasted it, and then he
ha ku
he was
okaa ha
it was that he
okaa g|u
it was night
sa g‡a
they two lay down
ha ku !hai ka
he was waiting for
kxoni ka kxa ka du
preparing the sand and did it
ku du se ha, "jua he re ha g|a'asi g‖a kore?
was trying him out, "where are this person's eyes?
ha g|a'asi re o kore?
where are his eyes?
ha g|a'asi re g‖a kore?"
where are his eyes placed?"

ka ihin kxa
then did thus with sand
ka du khoe n|ui, ka ka |oa tatabe
and did it some more, and they didn't blink
ka ha tam
so he didn't know
ka ko, "ka ke ha |ho hin ke..."
and said, "that this is his face here..."
ka ce ka gu ka, ka naq'am ka gua ka
and took it again, took it (how?)
du ha |ho ka, ka |oa tatabe
did his face but, but (his eyes) didn't blink
"ha g|a'asi re g||a kore?"
"where are his eyes placed?"
te ||'akaa ha
and then he
ka tsi g|ae du ha ha, ha g‡aisi
and then came to do his, his wrists
ka ka |oa tatabe
but they didn't blink
"jua he re ha g|a'asi g||a kore?"
"where are this person's eyes placed?"
te ||'a ha te koh kah ce koh
and then he did it and again did it
ha !'hom tzi sa kahinke
(to) his ankles here
ha ihin
he thus did
te ihin te ha g|a'asi taa...
and went like this and his eyes themselves...
"jua he ||oeh ha g|a'asi re g||a khuin ke wa?"
"are this person's eyes in fact placed here?"
aie
mother
"ehee, ha g|a'asi re ||oeh g||a khuin ke?"
"aha, are his eyes in fact placed here?"
te kua
and quickly
kua !oa ha te ko
quickly told him and said
"mtsa m, okaa ha...
"we two, it is when he...

mtsa, mtsa ka ku tza"
we two, we two are going to sleep"
'mhmm
yes
te sa
and they two
"mtsa tza ka n!homa-n!o ka g|ae
"we two are going to sleep and tomorrow will go
g|ae, g|ae gu ka g‖xaru"
go, go dig g‖xaru roots (Lapeirousia bainesii)"
‖'a ha koe n‖ae te sa tza te n!o te
then he thus spoke and they two slept and in the morning
g|ae gu ka g‖xaru te gu ka g‖xaru te gu ka g‖xaru te
went to dig g‖xaru and dug g‖xaru and dug g‖xaru and
|'u yaa da'a
built a fire
ha m, aie
yes, mother
te gu ka g‖xaru te gu ka g‖xaru te
and dug g‖xaru and dug g‖xaru and
ha |am ka ku ca'an koa ke
the sun had come to lie here (low on horizon)
te sa tsi ǂaeh
and they two arrived
te !xoana ka g‖xaru te !xoana te !xoana
and lived by the g‖xaru (patch) and lived and lived
ha tse !oa ha te ko "!'Hom!'homtzig|a'asi, n|a a ka |'u taqm g‖xaru n|ang mi sau"
he then told him and said "Eyes-on-his-Ankles, now you should drop your g‖xaru and let me roast it"
ha hin ‖'a kaoha ‖'a ha o kxuisi hin ke
these here were the words of this one, the god
"|'u taqm ka g‖xaru n|ang mi ka sau ka"
"put down the g‖xaru and let me roast it"
te ha g|ae ‖ohm !aihn-|'oa caan khuinke
and he went and chopped a wooden paddle that was this big
inn
yes
te
and
ha ku
he was

ha ku !oqm ka g‖xaru ka tsi g|ae ko ha ni n!un ǂxan ku taqm ka ha
he was wrapping up the g‖xaru and came and tried to stand far away while he was dropping (it) and he
ha taqm ka
he dropped it
ka ce ka g|ae !oqm ka tsi g|ae taqm
and then went to wrap it up again and came and dropped it
ka ce g|ae !oqm ka tsi g|ae taqm
and went again to wrap it up and then came and dropped it
te g!a !oqma din n!ang te ku tsi g|ae, te ha...
and went and wrapped up the last of it and was coming, and he...
"hatce re a ‖a'ike ku !oqm
"how is it that you are today wrapping
g‖xaru ka n!un ǂxaan ka ku taqm ne o hatce?
g‖xaru and standing far off and dropping it, is what?
ka a |oa n!un to'ma mi kae ma o hatce?"
that you don't stand close to me is what?"
‖'a ha ku khoe tsitsa'a kxui ha !'Hom!'homtzig|a'asi
then he was thus going about asking Eyes-on-his-Ankles
te
and
ha n|a ǂ'ai ‖'a !aihn|'oa ko
he certainly dipped that wooden paddle into
ko yaa da'a te ‖ae
into the fire and held it
te ‖'akaa ha tse
and then he
ka ha ǂaeh ku ǂ'ai ka ‖'akaa ha tse
and when he went and dipped it, then he
ha tse ku taqm ka g‖xaru te ha tse
he came and dropped the g‖xaru and then he
xaba ka ha g|a'asi ko yaa da'a
shoveled the fire over his eyes
te yaa da'a tse ku'u
and the fire burned
ku'u !'oahn ha te
burnt him down and
!ao ha
knocked him down
te ha g|a'asi ku'u !hara
and his eyes were burned until they split
‖'akaa ha tse kua
and then he quickly

du ha te du ha te du ha
did him and did him and did him
sau ǀxoa ha ko ka gǁxaru
roasted him with the gǁxaru
inn
yes
te sau te
and roasted and
ǁ'akaa ha tse goaq du te
then he long ago did and
du ǁ'a !ha te ko ka gǁxaru te ko ka !ha, te ǁ'akaa ha tse koah ǁae te tse gǀae u
did that meat and took the gǁxaru together with the meat and then he soon afterward picked it up and then went off
tjin n‡au ka tjuǀho
went off crying to the village
ee
yes
!'Hom!'homtzigǀa'asi
Eyes-on-his-Ankles